
VENDOR EVALUATION REPORT

Lead Generation Platform Comparison & Recommendation

An independent, evidence-based comparison of Apollo.io, ZoomInfo, Clay, and Oppora.ai — built to support Dechub's purchasing decision.

Apollo.io

ZoomInfo

Clay

Oppora.ai

Prepared for: Dechub

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Executive Summary

This report compares four shortlisted B2B lead-generation platforms — **Apollo.io**, **ZoomInfo**, **Clay**, and **Oppora.ai** — across pricing, data quality, automation depth, ease of use, and verified third-party reviews (G2, Capterra, Trustpilot, and independent analyst write-ups). The goal is to give Dechub a clear, genuine basis for choosing the right tool rather than relying on vendor marketing alone.

4

TOOLS EVALUATED

6

COMPARISON CRITERIA

20+

SOURCES REVIEWED

2026

PRICING DATA

The one-line story of each tool:

TOOL	WHAT IT FUNDAMENTALLY IS	BEST FIT
Apollo.io	All-in-one database + outreach engine	Lean SDR/sales teams wanting database + sequencing in one place
ZoomInfo	Premium enterprise data & intent platform	Enterprise / mid-market teams with five-figure budgets needing the deepest US data
Clay	Data enrichment & workflow orchestration layer	Technical RevOps / GTM engineering teams building custom pipelines
Oppora.ai	Agentic, fully-automated outbound system	Lean teams (like agencies) wanting outbound to run with minimal manual ops

A note on objectivity: Pricing and feature data is pulled from official vendor pricing pages, G2, Capterra, and independent analyst sites current as of mid-2026. Oppora.ai is a newer, smaller platform with a thinner independent review base than the other three — this is flagged throughout so the comparison stays honest rather than artificially balanced.

In this report:

02 Side-by-Side Comparison Matrix	Pricing, data size, automation, ease of use
03 Apollo.io — Deep Dive	Pricing, reviews, pros & cons
04 ZoomInfo — Deep Dive	Pricing, reviews, pros & cons
05 Clay — Deep Dive	Pricing, reviews, pros & cons
06 Oppora.ai — Deep Dive	Pricing, reviews, pros & cons
07 Recommendation	Which tool fits which scenario at Dechub

Side-by-Side Comparison Matrix

CRITERIA	APOLLO.IO	ZOOMINFO	CLAY	OPPORA.AI
Core Category	Sales intelligence + engagement (all-in-one)	Enterprise sales/ marketing intelligence	Data enrichment + workflow orchestration ("AI spreadsheet")	Agentic AI outbound system (data + outreach + follow-up)
Entry Pricing (2026)	Free tier; paid from ~\$49–59/user/mo, up to \$149/user/mo (Organization)	Not published; effectively \$14,995–\$40,000+/year, real-world spend often \$30K–\$60K/yr	Free tier; Launch ~\$167–185/mo; Growth ~\$495/mo; Enterprise custom	Free plan (500 contacts/mo); Pro \$34/mo flat; Max \$79/mo flat; Enterprise custom >20,000 contacts/mo
Pricing Model	Per-seat + consumable credits (can balloon with overages)	Custom quote, license + credit hybrid, annual contract, 3-seat minimum	Dual credit system — Data Credits (enrichment) + Actions (workflow steps)	Flat-rate plans, no per-seat fee; pay-as-you-go add-ons from \$7
Database Size	~275M+ contacts, 35M+ companies	~320M+ contact profiles — broadest, especially US/Canada enterprise	No native database — aggregates 100–150+ third-party providers via "waterfall"	700M+ B2B leads claimed (vendor-reported, not independently verified)
Outreach / Automation	Built-in email sequences, dialer, A/B testing (Pro+ tiers)	Engage add-on for outreach; mainly a data + intent platform	No native sending — must pair with a sequencing tool (Instantly, Smartlead, etc.)	Native email + LinkedIn outreach, AI reply handling, built-in inbox warm-up
Ease of Use	High — intuitive UI, fast onboarding	Moderate — powerful but feature-dense, real learning curve	Low–Moderate — spreadsheet UI looks simple, workflows are genuinely technical (20–40 hrs to first production workflow per G2/Reddit reports)	High — vendor and reviewers describe a simple, guided setup; smaller feature surface than the others
G2 Rating (approx.)	~4.7 / 5 (large review base)	~4.5 / 5 across 9,000–12,600+ reviews (note: Trustpilot only ~1.8/5 — see callout below)	Strong satisfaction scores; smaller, vocal review base; Trustpilot ~2.5/5 in some 2026 write-ups	Limited review volume so far; early reviews positive but the sample is thin
Most-Cited Weakness	Data accuracy inconsistency on phone numbers; credit overages	Price opacity, auto-renewal traps, steep add-on costs	Unpredictable credit burn; steep learning curve; support responsiveness	Smaller independent track record; AI/email-finding speed described as "average" by some reviewers
Best For	Small–mid sales/agency teams wanting one affordable, fast-to-launch tool	Enterprises with budget for the deepest, most accurate US contact data	Technical GTM/RevOps teams building custom, multi-source enrichment pipelines	Lean teams/agencies wanting outbound to run mostly hands-off at low flat cost

Reading the G2 vs. Trustpilot gap (ZoomInfo & Clay): Both tools show a noticeable gap between G2 scores (largely vendor-encouraged, post-sale reviews) and Trustpilot scores (more often left by frustrated former customers around billing or cancellation). For a purchase decision, weight both — G2 tells you about day-to-day usability; Trustpilot tells you about the buying and renewal experience.

Apollo.io — Deep Dive

Apollo.io

G2: ~4.7/5 | Capterra: ~4.6/5

Apollo positions itself as an all-in-one B2B sales intelligence and engagement platform: a contact database, email/LinkedIn sequencing, a dialer, and basic AI-assisted personalization in a single login. It's the most "ready to use on day one" of the four tools.

2026 Pricing

PLAN	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Free	\$0	~10,000 email credits/mo, 5 mobile credits, 2 active sequences, basic filters
Basic	\$49–59/user/mo (annual/monthly)	~30,000 credits/yr, unlimited sequences, CRM integrations
Professional	\$79–99/user/mo	A/B testing, US dialer, call recording with AI insights
Organization	\$119–149/user/mo (3-user min)	International dialer, custom LLM API access, advanced security/SSO

Caution: per-seat pricing plus consumable credits means real cost for a 5-person team can run \$600–800/month versus an advertised \$395 once credit overages and the \$149/mo inbound add-on are included (per Saleshandy's 2026 cost analysis).

WHAT REVIEWERS LIKE

- Most intuitive interface of the four — fast onboarding, AI-prompted lead search
- Genuinely "all-in-one": database + sequencing + dialer + CRM sync
- Large customer base (close to 100,000 paying customers) — mature, well-supported product

WHAT REVIEWERS FLAG

- Data accuracy inconsistent, especially mobile numbers — bounced emails reported
- Credit system + per-seat pricing makes costs unpredictable at scale
- Some plans require sharing CRM data back to Apollo to enrich its own database

"What I love most about Apollo is how intuitive the user interface is... Being able to input a simple prompt and get highly relevant leads along with the exact information I need saves a lot of time."

— Verified user review, Capterra (2026)

"Some users report outdated or incorrect emails and phone numbers, leading to bounced emails and wasted lead generation efforts."

— Synthesized from multiple G2 reviewer reports, cited in PhantomBuster analysis (2026)

ZoomInfo — Deep Dive

ZoomInfo

G2: ~4.5/5 (9,000–12,600+ reviews) | Trustpilot: ~1.8/5

ZoomInfo is the long-standing enterprise incumbent in B2B data — the largest single contact database of the four, with the deepest org-chart, technographic, and intent-signal layer. It is sold almost entirely through a custom, negotiated sales process rather than self-serve pricing.

2026 Pricing (third-party-estimated; ZoomInfo does not publish prices)

PLAN	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Lite	Free / ~\$130–750/mo	Small database slice, basic filters — built to compete with Apollo's free tier
Professional	~\$14,995/yr (3-seat min)	~5,000 annual bulk credits; +\$1,500–2,500 per extra seat/year
Advanced	~\$24,995/yr	~10,000 annual credits + 1,000 monthly user credits
Elite	~\$39,995+/yr	Full feature set, deepest add-on access (Intent, Chorus, Engage)

Real-world contracts commonly land at \$30,000–\$60,000/year once seats, intent data, and add-ons are factored in (Vendr-reported median: ~\$31,875/yr). This is 10–100x the entry cost of Apollo, Clay, or Oppora.

WHAT REVIEWERS LIKE

- Largest, most accurate database for US/Canada enterprise contacts
- #1 ranked in 26+ G2 categories — strongest intent-data and ABM tooling
- Deep CRM-native workflows (ZoomInfo Operations) for data hygiene at scale

WHAT REVIEWERS FLAG

- Opaque, negotiation-based pricing — first quote is described as "an anchor, not the real price"
- Auto-renewal and a strict 60-day cancellation window are the single most-cited source of buyer frustration (G2, Q1 2026)
- Mid-market/SMB record accuracy decays faster than enterprise records

"I absolutely love ZoomInfo Sales... The intent and filtering features are incredibly useful and important to me, especially when it comes to revenue amounts and locations."

— Verified user review, G2 (2026)

"Data decay on smaller accounts. Contact info stays sharp at the enterprise level, but mid-market and SMB records go stale faster. I cross-check before outreach."

— Verified user review, G2 (2026)

Why the G2/Trustpilot gap matters here: ZoomInfo's 4.5/5 G2 score reflects day-to-day product satisfaction. Its much lower Trustpilot score is driven almost entirely by contract and renewal experiences, not the product itself. If Dechub considers ZoomInfo, the contract terms deserve as much scrutiny as the data quality.

Clay — Deep Dive

Clay

G2: Strong satisfaction scores | Trustpilot: ~2.5/5 (2026)

Clay is not a lead database — it's an "AI spreadsheet" that pulls from 100–150+ third-party data providers in a waterfall (try source A, then B, then C until a match is found), plus an AI research agent ("Claygent") for custom enrichment. It sits *before* your outreach tool, not in place of one.

2026 Pricing (restructured March 2026)

PLAN	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Free	\$0	100 data credits/mo, 500 actions/mo, waterfall + Claygent included, max 200 rows/table
Launch	~\$167–185/mo	2,500–50,000 tiered data credits, phone enrichment, signal tracking
Growth	~\$495/mo	CRM sync, HTTP APIs, Web Intent, Ads integration, priority support
Enterprise	Custom	Dedicated CSM, highest credit ceilings, custom workflow support

Independent benchmark (SyncGTM, 2026): a fully enriched lead costs roughly \$3.75 on the Launch plan; a 5-step, 500-contact workflow on Growth runs an estimated \$325–600/month. Many of Clay's best LinkedIn workflows also assume an active LinkedIn Sales Navigator subscription (~\$99/seat/mo) on top.

WHAT REVIEWERS LIKE

- Highest data coverage of the four when waterfalling — independent test found 78% email match vs. 42% for Apollo alone
- Deep flexibility — custom workflows, own API keys, strong Slack community
- True pay-for-what-you-use model on data (no markup on AI token costs as of 2026)

WHAT REVIEWERS FLAG

- Steepest learning curve of the four — G2/Reddit reports cite 20–40 hours to a first production-ready workflow
- Credit burn is hard to predict; charges apply per attempt, not per success (failed lookups still cost credits)
- No native outreach — requires pairing with a separate sending tool, adding to total stack cost

"Clay solved the problem of manual, slow research for my outbound sales campaigns. Before using Clay, I spent hours every day checking LinkedIn and company websites..."

— Verified user review, G2 (2026)

"I also find the credit-based pricing a little difficult to predict. If you run a large list with too many enrichment steps, credits can disappear quickly, so you really have to plan your tasks carefully."

— Verified user review, G2 (2026)

Oppora.ai — Deep Dive

Oppora.ai

G2: Limited review volume | Capterra: Early-stage, positive

Oppora.ai is the newest and smallest of the four — an "agentic" outbound platform that bundles lead sourcing, enrichment, email + LinkedIn outreach, AI reply handling, and inbox warm-up into one flat-rate product. It's built explicitly to replace a stitched-together stack (e.g. Apollo + Instantly) at a fraction of the cost.

2026 Pricing

PLAN	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Free	\$0	~500 B2B contacts/mo with built-in outreach (vendor-stated)
Pro	\$34/mo flat	AI workflows, email outreach, follow-ups, multiple inboxes, CRM sync
Max	\$79/mo flat	Higher volume limits across workflows, emails, recipients, campaigns
Enterprise	Custom	For >20,000 contacts/month
Pay-as-you-go add-ons	From \$7	Lead search, email verification, and outreach as standalone purchases

No per-seat fee on Pro/Max — a meaningful structural difference from Apollo and ZoomInfo. The vendor's own positioning explicitly compares this to "\$200/month for 5,000 prospects" on a stitched Apollo + Instantly stack.

WHAT REVIEWERS LIKE

- Sleek, intuitive interface — reviewers report minimal onboarding friction
- Genuinely end-to-end: sourcing, enrichment, outreach, and follow-up in one flow, no tool-switching
- Lowest flat-rate entry cost of the four for small teams

WHAT REVIEWERS FLAG

- Email-finding speed and AI ICP-matching described as "average" by at least one verified G2 reviewer
- Smallest independent review base of the four — fewer data points to validate claims like the 700M+ database figure
- Reporting/customization described by Capterra reviewers as lighter than larger competitors ("wishlist, not a real gripe")

"The interface is very sleek and intuitive, so I didn't have to struggle to find any feature or option... The email finding takes a bit of time, so performance is average, I'd say."

— Verified user review, G2 (2026)

"Oppora is genuinely easy to pick up and use from day one. The sales management and lead generation tools are well thought out... Everything runs smoothly — no lag, no frustration."

— Verified user review, Capterra (2026)

Honesty check on Oppora.ai: much of the publicly available content on Oppora is published by Oppora's own blog, which naturally favors Oppora over competitors. The G2 and Capterra reviews quoted above are independently hosted and verified, but the sample size is small relative to Apollo, ZoomInfo, and Clay. Treat the "700M+ leads" figure as a vendor claim, not an independently audited number, and pilot the free plan before committing budget.

Recommendation

There is no single "best" tool in this category — each platform optimizes for a different shape of team and budget. Below is a decision framework based on the evidence above, mapped to scenarios relevant to an agency like Dechub.

If budget is the top constraint

Oppora.ai's flat \$34–79/mo with no per-seat fee is the cheapest path to a working outbound motion. Pilot the free plan (500 contacts/mo) first given its thinner review base.

If you want a proven, all-in-one tool

Apollo.io offers the best balance of database size, built-in outreach, and a mature support/review ecosystem — at a moderate, if creep-prone, per-seat price.

If data depth on enterprise US accounts is mission-critical

ZoomInfo remains the deepest database and intent layer — but only makes sense if Dechub's clients (e.g. enterprise prospecting for Tanishq-scale engagements) justify a \$30K+/year line item.

If you have technical capacity to build custom workflows

Clay delivers the highest data match rates of any tool tested, but requires real engineering time (20–40 hrs) to get production value — best suited to a dedicated RevOps resource, not a generalist marketer.

Suggested path for Dechub

Given Dechub's profile as a lean MarTech/AI agency running its own outbound (rather than an enterprise buying team with a five-figure data budget), the evidence points toward **Apollo.io** or **Oppora.ai** as the most practical starting points:

- **Apollo.io** if the priority is a mature, well-reviewed, all-in-one tool with a large support ecosystem and acceptable cost at small team size (3–5 seats).
- **Oppora.ai** if the priority is minimizing manual ops and per-seat cost, accepting some risk that comes with a newer, less-reviewed vendor.

ZoomInfo is difficult to justify unless a specific high-value enterprise client engagement requires its deeper US data; Clay is worth revisiting later if Dechub builds a dedicated RevOps/automation function that can absorb its learning curve.

Recommended next step: Run a 2–3 week parallel pilot — Apollo.io free/Basic tier vs. Oppora.ai free/Pro tier — against one real campaign (e.g. a Dechub Academy or GrowthOS prospecting list), then compare actual reply rate, data accuracy, and time-to-first-meeting before committing to an annual contract.

Sources: Apollo.io, ZoomInfo, Clay, and Oppora.ai official pricing pages; G2.com verified reviews; Capterra verified reviews; Trustpilot; and independent analyst write-ups (Saleshandy, PhantomBuster, Landbase, Amplemarket, SyncGTM, Cleanlist, Lindy, LaGrowthMachine) — all accessed June 2026. Pricing for ZoomInfo and Clay enterprise tiers is quote-based and not publicly listed by the vendors; figures here are third-party estimates and should be reconfirmed directly with sales before purchase.